Tourism Management Perspectives 23 (2017) 112–118

Contents lists available at ScienceDirect

Tourism Management Perspectives

journal homepage: www.elsevier.com/locate/tmp

Rethinking tourism scholarship beyond disciplinary convention

Edward B. Brooker [a,*], Marion Joppe [b]

[a] Pilon School of Business, Sheridan College, 7899 McLaughlin Rd., Brampton, Ontario L6Y 5H9, Canada
[b] School of Hospitality, Food, and Tourism Management, University of Guelph, 50 Stone Road East, Guelph, Ontario N1G 2W1, Canada

ARTICLE INFO

Article history:
Received 2 January 2017
Accepted 31 May 2017
Available online xxxx

Keywords:
Art
Artisan
Painter
Disciplines
Binaries
Liminality

ABSTRACT

We use artistic metaphors to simplify the varying disciplinary methods used by tourism scholars. Through the art perspective, we illustrate how and why the majority of current tourism epistemology is based on a 'painters' perspective, a preliminal approach focused on a disciplinary, structuralist approach. This represents a reactive stance to university and publishing expectations, where change, in the form of multi or post disciplinary thinking, as represented by an artist, is not always readily accepted. We note a small number of tourism scholars could be characterized as 'artisans, for while they recognize the value of art in a post disciplinary mode, they are not artists in their own right. The true artist, the one whose thinking totally disrupts that established by previous generations, has still to emerge.

© 2017 Elsevier Ltd. All rights reserved.

1. Introduction

Tourism scholarship has been debated by many authors in the past, each questioning to some degree what is tourism? How does it rank with other disciplines? Who is the most cited? Who is included? Who is excluded? Every research investigation, however presented, seeks to contribute to a deeper understanding of tourism, and its impact on society. As noble as these goals are, it is apparent that we have fallen well short of making a real mark on knowledge creation, according to various metrics and commentary.

A recent report (Becken, Miller, & Banhalmi-Zakar, 2016) focused on tourism academics practices and views and noted their propensity to remain insular – concerned more with the implications and consequences of their research and the manner in which it is measured (p. 16). Their interactions are primarily with their own kind, i.e. tourism academics, with only 10% engaging with other stakeholders (p. 4). These interactions could be coined incestual since they circulate their own ideas within their own 'club', forgoing an in-flow of fresh ideas.

Others have observed and commented on tourism's fragmented and disjointed scholarship (Benckendorff & Zehrer, 2013; Echtner & Jamal, 1997; Laws & Scott, 2015). Pritchard (2012) argues tourism scholarship remains beset by many ontological, epistemological and methodological shortcomings, such that its relevance and impact has been questioned (Fennell, 2013; Tribe, 2010). Airey, Tribe, Benckendorff, and Xiao (2015) paints a particularly devastating picture, referring to "…the production of inferior research, … the relatively low success rates in attracting research funding and the weaknesses in the impact of the work of the academy on the tourism community more generally" (p. 11).

They note:

- In the UK, out of 5332 awards from the Economic and Social Research Council between 2000 and 2011, only 29 or 0.5% related to tourism.
- In China, 123 projects or 0.07% of the National Science Foundation funding were granted for tourism-related projects during 2000–2011.
- In Australia, between 2003 and 2012, only eight Research Council grants were tourism out of a total of 4564 grants (0.002%).

It is not our intent to solve these issues here, for the matter is far too complex. In fact, we wish to take the opposite perspective, and suggest two areas where attention could be focused in order to incrementally improve, not innovate, tourism research output. The first is simplification of terminology to perhaps assist our understanding of what is actually taking place, and in so doing, better connect with practitioners. Secondly, despite employing a [simplicity vs. complexity] binary, we urge our peers to reduce the observed dependency on binaries to frame tourism research.

The two outcomes may seem separate, but the suggestion for simplicity arose from feedback and interactions with our peers as we explored, through various international conferences, the issue of binaries within tourism scholarship. Along the way, terms such as structuralism, post structuralism, disciplines, interdisciplinary, multidisciplinary, transdisciplinary, and post disciplinary entered our vocabulary, such that we tried to explain our insights through these terms. And we failed. For the terminology overshadowed a simple pattern that we noticed occurring after reviewing over 1000 abstracts in the top-three rated

* Corresponding author.
E-mail addresses: Edward.brooker@sheridancollege.ca (E.B. Brooker), mjoppe@uoguelph.ca (M. Joppe).

http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.tmp.2017.05.006
2211-9736/© 2017 Elsevier Ltd. All rights reserved.

tourism journals – *Annals of Tourism Research*, *Journal of Travel Research* and *Tourism Management* – namely a predisposition to rely on binaries to frame research. Hence the intersection of simplicity and binaries.

As we contemplated concepts such as structuralism and post structuralism, disciplines and post disciplinarity, we reverted back to a three-level innovation continuum based on an artistic personas framework (Brooker & Joppe, 2014), in keeping with Taleb's (2012) assertion that "just about anything can be mapped or classified into three categories" (p. 20). Inspired by art (Tribe, 2008), the opposing perspectives are dubbed the 'painter' and the 'artist'. An 'artisan' lies between the two poles (Fig. 1).

The majority of tourism scholars are 'painters', with a minority acting as 'artisans'. A number of painters need to shift into the artisan role, with a second shift required from artisan to artist. Put differently, tourism academics collectively need to consider research beyond their own discipline. An altered mindset reflects their positioning along the painter-artist continuum. The continuum further reflects the persona's disciplinary approaches – are they disposed to stay within existing boundaries? How far beyond these boundaries are they prepared to venture, assuming that they are so inclined?

1.1. The preponderance of binaries in tourism scholarship

Brooker and Joppe (2016) conducted a systematic review of journal abstracts and their key words published within the *Annals of Tourism Research*, *Journal of Travel Research*, and *Tourism Management*. These journals are the most prominent and highly cited tourism journals (Ballantyne, Packer, & Axelsen, 2009; Fennell, 2013; Gursoy & Sandstrom, 2016; Hsu & Yeung, 2003; McKercher, Law, & Lam, 2006; Perlancher, Zehrer, Matzler, & Abfalter, 2004; Ryan, 2005). They consistently receive the highest ranking across different rating systems, which indicates that they represent "… the best or leading journal[s] in [their] field" (Benckendorff & Zehrer, 2013, p. 128). Consequently, these journals are juxtaposed against all the other tourism journals, many of which specialize in a specific area – for example, the *Journal of Sustainable Tourism*, *Journal of Travel and Tourism Marketing* or the *Journal of Vacation Marketing*. Between 2013 and 2015, 782 articles were published in these journals. 307 (39%) of these addressed binaries with fully half (174) of these appearing in *Tourism Management*, followed by the *Journal of Travel Research* (74) and *Annals of Tourism Research* (60). Predominantly, these articles dealt with topics in the social sciences, with only *Tourism Management* publishing a notable number of business-oriented topics. Even when reaching further back to 2007 and analyzing 1094 abstracts in alternative years to 2015 there were 410 (37%) papers that included binaries (Table 1).

The numbers varied between the years, but have for the most part ranged between 30 and 40%, with noted outliers. However, the order of the top two journals was inversed with the structuralist approach appearing to be most prevalent within the *Journal of Travel Research*, and lesser within *Tourism Management* and *Annals of Tourism Research*.

These findings contrast with Tribe, Dann, and Jamal's (2015) suggestion that a 'big shift in tourism thinking has been away from binaries to a much more fluid and messy understanding of their underlying phenomena (Cloke & Johnson, 2005). Hence Hosts and Guests, Home and Away, Backstage and Frontstage, Authentic and Inauthentic, the Exotic and the Everyday, Work and Leisure have all been critiqued and reworked" (p. 32). We would suggest that this is not in fact the case.

Fig. 1. Painter–Artisan–Artist continuum.

Table 1
Binary usage in three top-rated tourism journals.

	Annals of tourism research			Journal of travel research			Tourism management		
	# of articles	# with binaries	%	# of articles	# with binaries	%	# of articles	# with binaries	%
2007	50	16	32%	40	16	40%	150	50	33%
2009	29	6	21%	39	21	54%	90	34	38%
2011	71	20	28%	48	24	50%	128	47	37%
2013	72	31	43%	57	20	35%	130	42	32%
2015	34	17	50%	35	15	43%	121	51	42%
Total	256	90	35%	219	96	44%	619	224	36%

1.2. The preliminal structural painter

The vast majority of tourism researchers are 'painters, as most interact only with their own kind (Becken et al., 2016) a pattern that is common to many industries, organizations and tribes. The opposing perspectives of a painter and an artist can be best understood in the context of van Gennep's (1960) Rites of Passage. Our lives are framed by three major phases: the rites of separation from a previous world or preliminal rites; transitional or liminal rites; and postliminal reincorporation into the world. This pattern can be found everywhere from movie scripts (e.g. the Pixar Pitch[1]) to the tourism experience: an initial 'leaving' [escaping] phase of home to introduce a bit of disorder to their regular and routinized daily lives (Minca & Oakes, 2006, p. 14). The 'painter' represents the preliminal stage, in contrast to the artist's postliminal reincorporation. In other words, the 'painter' has 'not left', but remains corralled by existing boundaries, fenced in. Its constituents are capable and knowledgeable but are content to remain within existing boundaries, as established by others. Disciplinary thinking - institutionalized knowledge production (Jessop & Sum, 2001; Turner, 2002) represents such a boundary. Within modern academia, these frameworks are known as disciplines. They establish and regulate boundaries that define the subject matter (Thompson Klein, 1996). Coles, Hall, and Duval (2006) go as far as to suggest "disciplines as we understand them today are an artefact of previous academic divisions of labour which dominate current institutional regimes" (p. 293).

The scholarly 'painter' sees his or her production replicated by peers, each conforming to the established culture within their disciplines and within their academic situations. They are high self-monitors (Snyder, 1987), conforming individuals who communicate perceived correct messages to peers and/or supervisors, partially out of fear and partially to earn credits within their group. They focus on what it takes to be accepted, to please, or comply with others – to conform to the metrics established by their institution to determine the quantity, rather than quality, of their output. Essentially they are deferential followers, managing the status quo. As a result their 'art' is similar to that of their peers, based in part on personal rather than broader (sectoral) perspectives. They are most comfortable interacting within a strong network, as found within their own discipline.

Universities' expectations to produce research within certain standards puts pressure on tourism scholars to adopt a painter's attitude, risking being crushed by anything that does not seem to conform to these 'laws' (Clarke, 2014, p. 181). Succumbing to the managerial gaze with its associated metrics and indicators (Airey et al., 2015), they have largely fallen in line with the established view as to what tourism studies should include, what methodologies are acceptable and how results should be presented. What is perceived as a desirable academic identity is about matching a set of standards of 'excellence' – the ticking

[1] Pixar Animation is one of the most successful studios in movie history (Pink, 2012, p. 170). Each Pixar movie follows a similar six-line narrative, known as a Pixar Pitch, which shifts the story line from its opening context, through a change, culminating with the result of that change.

of the boxes (Munar, 2016, p. 1) that is part of the audit culture now increasingly wide-spread in academia, supposedly because it provides "greater ease and objectivity in how best to allocate scarce resources and assign merit" (Fennell, 2013, p. 417). Journals contribute to maintaining this status quo by imposing the often very traditional rules for what type of research is accepted for publication as Tribe's (2010) research clearly showed. Editors seek out papers that have the greatest potential to lead to further citations of that particular journal (Sirakaya-Turk, personal communication, December 15, 2016).

A painter's key feature is a reliance on a system of binary opposition to make sense of and order in the world. Binary oppositions have dominated the theoretical landscape for centuries, structuring our language, thought, actions, research, and expression. They were used with great skill by ancient Greek philosophers (Eade, 2011), so much so that Western society is conditioned to see situations in opposing pairs, referred to as dualisms, binaries or opposable thinking. Their frequency is pervasive, suggesting an either/or perspective is all that is needed to analyze a situation. Consequently, challenging binary divisions is difficult and highly problematic (Sibley, 2001, p. 241).

It is therefore not surprising to see binaries used in early tourism scholarship (Franklin, 2004), focusing on good vs. evil (see Singh, 2012). MacCannell's (1976) 'pro-tourist' stakeholders viewed tourism as a fast-track economic development opportunity. The 'anti-tourist' described the opposite perspective. This dualism is also found in the titles of tourism research such as Young's (1973) critical discussion *Tourism-Blessing or Blight?* and Dixit and Tüting's (1986) *Bikas-Binas*: *Development-Destruction*. Crick (1988) argued both of these opposites are incorrect, suggesting that tourism is neither a godsend nor an evil.

Valene Smith (1976), and many since, addressed the classic host (the oppressed) vs. the guest (the oppressor) binary in tourism. O'Reilly (2000) comments on tourism's intangible concept, noting that many, including Smith (1976) and Voase (1995), define tourism "more by what it is not than by what it is – it is not home and it is not work; it is a change of scenery and lifestyle, an inversion of the normal" (p. 43). Urry (1990) retained MacCannell's structural ontology, echoing the traditional perspective that tourism represents a basic binary providing tourists with an opportunity for an extraordinary experience to offset the ordinary. "Minimally there must be certain aspects of the place to be visited which distinguish it from what is conventionally encountered in everyday life. Tourism results from a basic binary division between ordinary/everyday and the extraordinary" (p. 11).

Turner (1985) questioned the value of binaries, noting: "various models dealing with oppositional logical relations … seem to be applicable mainly to tribal or early agrarian societies where work and life tend to be governed by seasonal and ecological rhythms" (p. 61). He further notes:

> "The models apply in situations where the rules underlying the generation of cultural patterns tend to seek out the binary "Yin-Yang," forms suggested by simple, natural oppositions such as hot/cold, wet/dry, cultivated/wild, male/female, summer/winter, plenty/scarcity, and the like. The main social and cultural structures tend to become modeled on these cosmological principles, which determines even the layout of cities and villages, the design of houses, and the shape and spatial placement of different types of cultivated land" (p. 61).

The painter's reliance on binaries appears to be an unquestioned, second-nature (Munar, 2016, p. 135). For example, Xiao, Jafari, Cloke, and Tribe's (2013) review of the 40 year history of the *Annals of Tourism Research* is full of references to various classic binaries (e.g. core-periphery, urban-rural fringe, negative-positive aspects, and first timer's-repeater's behaviour (p. 366–367) without questioning its structuralist value. Similarly, Urry's work is honoured in a 2015 *International Journal of Culture, Tourism and Hospitality Research* volume (Woodside, 2015), also without noting its reliance on structuralism. Binaries such as host-guest, the everyday-extraordinary, home-away, and profane-sacred and so on are therefore perpetuated. The allure of thinking in 'either-or' binary terms per se is not the problem; it is the misuse/overuse of the binary (Kikuchi, 2006) that leads to preconditioned thinking to 'see' issues in a certain way (Pernecky, Munar, & Wheeler, 2016b).

Binary utilization has been investigated in other subject areas – for example, geography (Olsson, 1980), management (Linstead, 1985), nursing (Kikuchi, 2006) and the social sciences in general (Geertz, 1980). A 2015 Humanities Education and Research Association (HERA) conference questioned whether the social sciences were too dependent on binaries and if alternative frameworks could be used (HERA, 2015).

Binaries are symptomatic of academia's reliance on standardization. The sameness accentuates efficiency, an approach that Ridley (2015), citing Menken, suggests "… does not spread enlightenment … but simply reduces as many individuals as possible to the same safe level, to breed a standard citizen" (p. 189). Catmull (2014) questions this norm, noting "if we put too much structure on it, we will kill it. There is a fine balance between providing some structure [and safety] – but also letting it get messy and stay messy for a while" (p. 233).

Yet the painter conforms, often without comment, to standardization initiatives. Their painting style stays within the lines in a structuralist approach. Structuralism focuses on how social structures and institutions constrain the behaviour of people (Peet, 1998).

By nature, human beings are risk averse. We prefer the safe and conventional, and unconsciously shy away from novel, and potentially uncomfortable situation. Our first instinct is often to reject novelty, looking for reasons why unfamiliar concepts might fail. The painter mindset therefore is taken advantage of, as universities establish a set of standards of excellence for its employees to follow. This systemic approach could lead to what Suzanne Ryan (2012, p. 3) cites as 'zombification' where a [painter] simply responds to stimuli established and bureaucratically enforced by universities/management. Zombiedom is a form of resistance to change, an alternative to personally exiting the system.

For some, the boundaries are distinct. Currently, the research voice is dominated by existing perspectives, including, but not exclusive to a Western-centred lens. McKercher (2016), for example, categorizes tourism by technical and heuristic definitions. The technical classification strives to place tourism inside a clearly defined box (minimum distance), so that it can be 'counted,' interpreted, and analyzed. It is arbitrary and works for its purpose, but does not capture its experiential side. Heuristic definitions, on the other hand, try to define the phenomenon of tourism. They are more inclusive and address the weaknesses found in the technical definition. But, it is difficult to 'count' tourism using this definition.

Boundaries, however formed, provide a comfort level, an understanding of what is and what is not included, resulting in an overall contentment, if not complacency (Brooker, 2011). These borders may not be as clear within tourism, as noted in ongoing debates as to what tourism entails. Realizing that this could well represent an opportunity, Airey et al. (2015) suggested that tourism lends itself well "both to drawing on a broad range of topics and issues and to using a wide range of approaches and methods of research" (p. 148). This opportunity could be seized, effectively countering the neoliberal management agenda, but it requires "tourism to join forces across the disciplines and national boundaries of universities" (p. 148). The artisan is apt to take on this role, given its characteristics as noted in Table 2.

1.3. The liminal artisan

Positioned between the preliminal painter and the postdisciplinary artist is the liminal artisan. The word liminal is derived from limen – the Latin word for boundary or threshold. It is a 'twilight zone' which represents a separation from the norm, a potential domain, the unknown, adventure, excitement, and creativity. Not surprisingly, the

Table 2
Comparing the painter, artisan, and artist continuum in a tourism research context (adapted from Brooker & Joppe, 2014).

	Painter	Artisan	Artist
Horizon focus	Now	New	Next
Change artist	Imitate	Differentiate	Innovate
Discipline position	Inside	Inside	Outside
Change preference	Status quo	Periodically challenge status quo	Disrupts status quo
Perspective	See Black/white binaries	See shades of grey	See between spaces
Rogers's innovation diffusion	Majority (early/late)	Early adopter	Innovator
Rogers's percentage	68% of population	13.5% of population	2.5% of population
Primary question	What?	How?	Why?
Network ties	Strong	Weaker	Weak
Framework	Structural	Poststructural	Poststructural
Focus	Short term	Medium term	Long term
Focus	Tangible	Potential	Intangible
Focus	Either/or	And	Neither
Disrupt status quo	Minimal	Periodic	Ongoing
Knowledge level	Codified	Codified/Tacit	Tacit
Discipline	Disciplinary	Multi-/Inter/Transdisciplinary	Postdisciplinary
Self-monitor	High	Lower	Low
Approach	Exclusive	Inclusive	Forward
Description	Researcher	Leader	Pioneer/rebel
Outreach	Journals	Critical Tourism Studies	To be determined
	Industry Conferences	TEFI	

'zone' is not for the faint-of-heart, nor for those who do not appreciate change. Turner (1985) describes the twilight zone as 'betwixt and between', a liminal zone between separation and reconnection.

Others refer to this space as a grey zone (Munar, 2016), a sweet spot between the known and the unknown (Catmull, 2014, p. 224), the black and the white. The in between grey zone is rich in opportunities for unexplored insights. Wescott (2016) notes the tendency within academia to clump their focus on the same few topics. "The space between the clumps gets neglected."

Understanding the inherent grey nuances between these black and white clumps requires temporarily intermingling with 'others' beyond existing [disciplinary] boundaries research agendas, writing(s), and conferences. Hybrid knowledge resists the inherent insularity imposed by disciplines (Coles, Hall, & Duval, 2016, p. 378). It also defies the either/or binary logic. Clarke (2014) eloquently suggests, "knowledge forming takes place in the in-between, in the way that a melody is not experienced as a series of distinct notes but rather in the movements that carry the melody forward, and back (p. 180).

From ontological and epistemological perspectives, liminal *artisans* are a small group of insiders who are able to conceptualize beyond their own discipline. They realize that interdisciplinary engagement with art presents new opportunities to see (Clarke, 2014, p. 179). This phenomenon has been described as vuja de, a sense of seeing everything everyone else does, but understanding it differently (Bailey, 2012, p. 1). It questions the way things are, intuitively grasping the foreseeable future, thereby breaking with the conventional. It understands that old and seemingly universalized understandings can no longer be assumed to apply (Hollinshead, 2016, p. 350). In contrast to merely surviving (Ryan, 2012), and reacting to change, an artisan takes on a leadership role, acknowledging the painters' challenges, but nonetheless instigates change to improve the overall manner in which [tourism] research is undertaken and disseminated. Artisans are proactive, introducing what Tribe (2005) describes as *new* tourism studies research (p. 5) that has moved beyond the structuralist approaches described earlier. They represent the Pixar Pitch's change phase, and the liminal transition period of van Gennep's Rites of Passage.

Artisans purposely and periodically explore beyond existing disciplinary boundaries, leaving their nest in search for overlooked insights that lie between the structuralist's black and white worlds. They do so to instigate what they believe is much needed change. They see what others do not, and try to convince the others to follow their lead, for they see the value in the grey zone between structured binaries.

The artisan's mindset requires a sense of curiosity and adventure to see what many do not. Insights are gained by interacting with weaker networks in different geographies, contexts, and disciplines which provide fresh, new perspectives that are not currently circulating within their own strong, disciplinary network. For some, this means borrowing creative research practices and techniques from art (Clarke, 2014, p. 179). Kennedy (2016) eloquently depicts these individuals as bees carrying pollen flying to a new flower, able to bring together knowledge from several fields. They are 'go-betweens', intellectual middlemen (Duhigg, 2016) who transfer knowledge between different groups or disciplines. People connected across groups are more familiar with alternative thinking and behaviours. They are more likely to express ideas and have ideas evaluated as valuable. Their views respectfully challenge existing perceptions, based on knowing which ideas had already succeeded elsewhere, creating a different lens to view the world. By developing more sophisticated theoretical frameworks, artisans hear the voices of people involved in the practices and processes of tourism development and management (Hannam & Knox, 2010, p. 5).

Artisans are known by alternative monikers, such as 'tempered radicals', defined by Meyerson (2001) as an organizational insider who is treated like an outsider because their values are at odds with the dominant culture. They survive bureaucratic hairballs (MacKenzie, 1998) by thinking on their own while remaining connected to the overall mission – recognizing new opportunities to strengthen tourism studies.

Snyder (1987) would describe their mindset as a 'low-self monitor' – one who can ascertain his/her own understanding of their situation and express an original viewpoint, while relying on their own inner attitudes and emotions. The low self-monitor is more apt to innovate, working within a system, with a goal to push, not tear, the envelope. As Martin (2013) notes, "the thing is, you don't want to step too far outside the consensus. You need to deepen it maybe." He advocates what others refer to as the 70–20-10 rule, whereby 70% of the effort improves what is already in place, while 30% focuses on innovative thinking. The level of disruption is accordingly varied, with 20% based on lifting, shifting and adapting successful ideas found elsewhere. Ten percent is devoted to more radical innovation, or what we would describe as 'creating art'.

Tourism artisans have developed a number of initiatives, networks, and conferences, each from an insider's perspective, designed to steer the overall focus in a broader *new* direction. Examples include Critical Tourism Studies (CTS), and the Tourism Education Futures Initiative

(TEFI), each championing non-bureaucratized forms of scholarship which act as an alternative to the increasingly formalized academic institutions. These epistemological initiatives question existing dominant approaches, encouraging dissent and autonomy in tourism knowledge production. Each pushes the "necessity for plural knowability" (Hollinshead, 2016, p. 352).

The CTS network exemplifies the artisan character. It was founded in 2005 "to provide a space for sharing and connection for those seeking to create positive social change in and through tourism scholarship, education and practice…The dreamers [aka *artisans*] … worked to establish an inclusive environment that would help legitimize the critical school of thought in tourism studies and create space for alternative voices" (CTSNA, 2017).

The amount of research into tourism published by, in what Wardle and Buckley (2014) call "non-tourism journals", (p. 163) is striking and demonstrates that "significant advances are appearing in disciplinary domains not always immediately associated with tourism and beyond the dedicated publication outlets usually associated with the subject" (Coles et al., 2016, p. 374). Indeed, Coles et al. (2016, p. 163) found that when tourism is categorized by field of knowledge and journal category, then the number of tourism-related articles that are published in tourism journals is in the minority with the exception of the "social sciences" and "business, management, and accounting" categories. Considering the complexity of the nature of tourism, it is not surprising that scholars from a wide range of disciplines have been interested in this phenomenon and indeed, scholars are increasingly relying on multi-, inter-, and transdisciplinary approaches. This process of the progressive decompartmentalization of disciplines (Darbellay, 2016) allows the *artisan* access to a much broader understanding of the issues by drawing on multiple perspectives and methodologies, without however being completely free of disciplinary boundaries since each one comes from an insider's viewpoint.

Levitt's (1960) seminal *Marketing Myopia* article advocates a similar message: management (however defined) has failed to allow growth [in thinking] as it holds onto a preconceived idea as to what is and what is not deemed important. These same phases are applicable to an individual, group, organization, industry or discipline as each evolves from an existing and accepted form, norms, boundaries and paradigms which guide the understanding of the external world (Tribe, 1997).

1.4. Art and tourism scholarship

Art provides a fresh approach to present issues within tourism (Tribe, 2008), so the topic has received some attention in the literature. See for example Graburn's (1976) consumption of art by tourists, Cohen's (1993) ethnic art for tourists, and Crouch and Lubbren (2003)'s visual culture and tourism. Art can be defined as an expression or application of human creativity and imagination. It presents ideas and attitudes that are not readily available in our familiar environments. Art, creativity, imagination, innovation and similar notions are thus formed from the unfamiliar.

Making art and viewing art are different at their core (Bayles & Orland, 1993, p. 4). A literature review does not propel any 'artist' to the forefront, although a small number correlate art with understanding tourism. Tribe (2008) notes "art extends our insights beyond the literal, and more easily allows the symbolic, the impressionistic, the imaginative, the ironic and the surreal to extend our thinking' (p. 941). Pernecky, Munar, and Feighery (2016a); Pernecky et al. (2016b) independently refer to the 'artist' in their reflections on 'existential postdisciplinarity'. They see 'art' as a metaphor. "It is through the notion of art that we argue the truth is never absolute but elusive" (p. 390). "Art is life. Not reiterative. Not imitative, ever. It's always new" (Tripp, 2016, p. 42).

Our research could be art, but we do not like to stray out of our comfort zones, preferring to interact with our own herd. Occasionally we are prodded to and provoked by the world of art (deBotton & Armstron, 2013), but these are generally short-term bursts with minimal impact on our outputs. Simply put, we need more art!

Art attempts to seize logic and meaning out of reality in unusual manners. It forces us to try to make sense of what it is that we are seeing, rather than simply taking the concept(s) for granted (Vaill, 1989, p. 39). Making art is difficult, for it means working in the face of uncertainly, living with doubt, and for purely intrinsic rewards. Therefore making art and viewing art are different at their core (Bayles & Orland, 1993, p. 4). It is this difference that underscores tourism scholarship, where few, if any, artists can be found. Most 'simply' view art, rather than make it.

Artists challenge the scope of what is possible, desirable and credible. In true rebel form, they question conventional norms, and processes of knowledge production. Instead, they reach beyond existing structures and conceptualization, forging connections between different disciplines (Pernecky, Munar & Feighery, 2016, p. 432) to uncover the *next* level interpretation of what is truly important. Artists are driven pioneers. Earlier, Brooker and Joppe (2014) outlined several key characteristics of an artist's persona (Table 2).

These included 'next' level thinking, innovation, outsider positioning, disruptive, possessing weak network ties (*Granovetter*, 1973), and acting with a low self-monitor approach (Snyder, 1987).

Artists use art as an instrument to challenge audiences, juxtaposing new methods and approaches against more traditional styles. They mix and blend different styles to communicate what he or she sees and feels is important (Pernecky et al., 2016a, 2016b, p. 392). Avant garde artists continually charter new territory, revising their processes to offer revolutionary perspectives.

Such exploration takes time, a luxury for many academics who are not afforded the opportunity to simply ponder and make sense of what is happening within their world, and the world of others, due to the audit culture within many academic settings (Fennell, 2013, p. 418). Conversely, the artist focuses on future developments, not sidetracked with concerns of needing to drag and convince the others to join the revolution.

2. Conclusion

The various approaches to tourism studies can be clearly understood through an art perspective. The majority of scholars "stay close to home", maintaining a *painter's* perspective, while finding ways and means to conform to the demands put on them by their universities, publishers, and others within their strong network. Ryan (2012) submits that academics are not equipped to organize resistance to the various changes occurring within their spheres, relying instead on surviving within the academy (p. 7). The painter mindset is evident in her concluding comments, which summarize many academics' frustration:

> Perhaps zombiedom can be construed as an effective form of resistance, a form that goes beyond survival to protecting and hopefully nourishing the kernel of desire for future emancipation. But the question remains as to whether we can survive by simply sheltering away, waiting for the neoliberal storm to pass? And, even if we do, will we have the memory, the energy, the identity left to reactivate the academy as we would like it (p. 10). These bureaucratic structures have varying levels of influence, ranging from global quality metrics (the journal citation index, international ranking systems, quality accreditation agencies, etc.) to national and local rules and procedures (Marginson & van der Wende, 2007).

A small group of post structural artisans continually seek opportunities to access a much broader understanding of the issues, drawing on a weaker network, multiple perspectives and methodologies, but still from an insiders' perspective, not completely free of disciplinary boundaries. A minority continually push out these boundaries, in a mildly

rebellious manner, advocating others to join in their 'revolution'. They see the value of next level art, but they themselves are not the artist. They are akin to the biblical story of John the Baptist, advocating the emergence of the next level of transformation, but unequipped to act as THE artist.

References

Airey, D., Tribe, J., Benckendorff, P., & Xiao, H. (2015). The managerial gaze: The long tail of tourism education and research. *Journal of Travel Research*, *54*(2), 139–151.

Bailey, S. (2012). *The vuja de moment!* Windermere, FL: Brilliance Institute, Inc.

Ballantyne, R., Packer, J., & Axelsen, M. (2009). Trends in tourism research. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *36*(1), 149–152.

Bayles, D., & Orland, T. (1993). *Art & fear*. Santa Cruz, CA: The Image Continuum.

Becken, S., Miller, G., & Banhalmi-Zakar, Z. (2016). *Making an impact – Practices and views of tourism academics*. Brisbane: Griffith Institute for Tourism Research.

Benckendorff, P., & Zehrer, A. (2013). A network analysis of tourism research. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *43*, 121–143.

deBotton, A., & Armstron, J. (2013). *Art as therapy*. London: Phaidon Press.

Brooker, E. (2011). *In search of radical innovation within the Australian outdoor hospitality industry*. Griffith University, Australia: Unpublished doctoral dissertation.

Brooker, E., & Joppe, M. (2014). Developing a tourism innovation typology: Leveraging liminal insights. *Journal of Travel Research*, *53*(4), 500–508.

Brooker, E., & Joppe, M. (2016). Unwellness in tourism scholarship: Seeing the world as black and white. In M. C. Miller, H. Mair, M. Muldoon, B. S. R. Grimwood, K. Caton, & J. Leeming (Eds.), *Tourism and wellness: Travel for the good of us all? Proceedings of the 1st critical tourism studies North America conference. 2016*. Waterloo, ON: Department of Recreation and Leisure Studies, University of Waterloo.

Catmull, E. (2014). *Creativity, Inc.: Overcoming the unseen forces that stand in the way of true inspiration*. Toronto: Random House Canada.

Clarke, J. (2014). Disciplinary boundaries between art and anthropology. *Journal of Visual Art Practice*, *13*(3), 178–191.

Cloke, P., & Johnson, R. (Eds.). (2005). *Spaces of geographical thought: Deconstructing human geography's binaries*. London: Sage Publications.

Cohen, E. (1993). Investigating tourist arts. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *20*, 1–8.

Coles, T., Hall, C. M., & Duval, D. T. (2006). Tourism and post-disciplinary inquiry. *Current Issues in Tourism*, *9*(4/5), 293–319.

Coles, T., Hall, C. M., & Duval, D. T. (2016). Tourism and postdisciplinarity: Back to the future. *Tourism Analysis*, *21*(4), 373–387.

Crick, M. (1988). Sun, sex, sight, savings and servility: Representatives of international tourism in the social sciences. *Criticism, Heresay, and Interpretation*, *1*(1), 37–65.

Critical Tourism Studies North America (2017). Tourism and Wellness: Travel for the Good of All? In M. Miller, H. Mair, M. Muldoon, B. Grimwood, K. Caton, & J. Leeming (Eds.), *Conference Proceedings* Huntsville, Ontario, Canada: August 1–5, 2016.

Crouch, D., & Lubbren, N. (Eds.). (2003). *Visual culture and tourism*. Oxford: Berg.

Darbellay, F. (2016). From disciplinarity to postdisciplinarity: Tourism studies dedisciplined. *Tourism Analysis*, *21*(4), 363–372.

Dixit, K., & Tüting, L. (1986). *Bikas-binas: Development-destruction? The change in life and environment of the Himalaya*. Geobuch.

Duhigg, C. (2016). *Smarter faster better*. Toronto: Doubleday Canada.

Eade, J. (2011). The expanding field of pilgrimage studies: Beyond binaries. *Tourism*, *59*(3), 387–389.

Echtner, C., & Jamal, T. (1997). The disciplinary dilemma of tourism studies. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *24*(4), 868–883.

Fennell, D. (2013). The ethics of excellence in tourism research. *Journal of Travel Research*, *52*(4), 417–425.

Franklin, A. (2004). Tourism as an ordering: Towards a new ontology of tourism. *Tourist Studies*, *4*(3), 277–301.

Geertz, C. (1980). Blurred genres: The reconfiguration of social thought. *American Scholar*, *49*, 165–178.

van Gennep, A. (1960). *Les rites de passage [the rites of passage]*. Paris: Emile Nourry.

Graburn, N. (1976). *Ethnic and tourism arts: Cultural expressions from the fourth world*. Berkley: University of California Press.

Granovetter, M. (1973). The strength of weak ties. *American Journal of Sociology*, *78*(6), 1360–1380.

Gursoy, D., & Sandstrom, J. K. (2016). An updated ranking of hospitality and tourism journals. *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Research*, *40*(1), 3–18.

Hannam, K., & Knox, D. (2010). *Understanding tourism: A critical introduction*. London: Sage Publications.

Hollinshead, K. (2016). Postdisciplinarity and the rise of intellectual openness: The need for "plural knowability" in tourism studies. *Tourism Analysis*, *21*, 349–361.

Hsu, C., & Yeung, M. (2003). Perceived ranking of hospitality and tourism journals and school. *Proceedings of the first APAC-CHRIE conference* (pp. 496–508). Hong Kong SAR: APac-CHRIE.

Humanities Education and Research Association (2015). Retrieved from http://h-e-r-a.org/Conferences/2015%20San%20Francisco/hera_2015_conference.htm.

Jessop, B., & Sum, N. L. (2001). Pre-disciplinary and postdisciplinary perspectives. *New Political Economy*, *6*(1), 89–101.

Kennedy, P. (2016). *Inventology: How we dream up things that change the world*. New York: Eamon Dolan/Houghton Mifflin Harcourt.

Kikuchi, J. (2006). The binary: An obstacle to scholarly nursing discourse? *Nursing Philosophy*, *7*, 100–103.

Laws, E., & Scott, N. (2015). Building from other disciplines. *Tourism Recreation Research*, *49*(1), 48–58.

Levitt, T. (1960). Marketing myopia. *Harvard Business Review*, *38*, 22–47.

Linstead, S. (1985). Breaking the purity rule: Industrial sabotage and the symbolic process. *Personal Review*, *3*, 12–19.

MacCannell, D. (1976). *The tourist: A new theory of the leisure class*. New York: Schocken Books.

MacKenzie, G. (1998). *Orbiting the giant hairball*. New York: Viking.

Marginson, S., & van der Wende, M. (2007). Globalisation and higher education. *OECD education working papers*. *8*. OECD publishing. http://dx.doi.org/10.1787/173831738240 (Accessed 17 August 2016).

Martin, R. (2013). In R. Martin, & K. Christensen (Eds.), *Rotman on design: The best on design thinking from Rotman magazine*. Toronto: University of Toronto Press.

McKercher, B. (2016). Re: Adulteration of the meaning of tourism. (Retrieved September 11, 2016 from) https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?tab=wm#inbox/1571723eedb316dd.

McKercher, B., Law, R., & Lam, T. (2006). Rating tourism and hospitality journals. *Tourism Management*, *27*, 1235–1252.

Meyerson, D. E. (2001). *Tempered radicals: How people use difference to inspire change at work*. Boston: Harvard Business School Press.

Minca, C., & Oakes, T. (2006). Introduction: Traveling paradoxes. In C. Minca, & T. Oakes (Eds.), *Travels in paradox: Remapping tourism* (pp. 1–21). Rowan & Littlefield: Lanham.

Munar, A. M., Munar, A. M., & Jamal, T. (2016a). The house of tourism studies and the systemic paradigm. *Tourism research paradigms: Critical and emergent knowledges* (pp. 131–153). Emerald Group Publishing Limited.

Olsson, G. (1980). *Bird in egg*. London: Pion.

O'Reilly, K. (2000). *The British on the Costa del Sol: Transnational identities and local communities*. London: Routledge.

Peet, R. (1998). *Modern geographical thought*. Oxford: Blackwell Publishing.

Perlancher, H., Zehrer, A., Matzler, K., & Abfalter, D. (2004). A ranking of international tourism and hospitality journals. *Journal of Travel Research*, *42*, 328–333.

Pernecky, T., Munar, A. M., & Feighery, W. (2016a). Tourism in a postdisciplinary milieu: Final demarcation points. *Tourism Analysis*, *21*, 431–434.

Pernecky, T., Munar, A. M., & Wheeler, B. (2016b). Existential postdisciplinarity: Personal journeys into tourism, art, and freedom. *Tourism Analysis*, *21*, 389–401.

Pink, D. (2012). *To sell is human*. New York: Riverhead Books.

Pritchard, A. (2012). Critical tourism research. In I. Ateljevic, N. Morgan, & A. Pritchard (Eds.), *The critical turn in tourism studies: Creating an academy of hope* (pp. 11–13). Oxon: Routledge.

Ridley, M. (2015). *The evolution of everything*. New York: HarperCollins.

Ryan, C. (2005). The ranking and rating of academics and journals in tourism research. *Tourism Management*, *26*, 657–662.

Ryan, S. (2012). Academic zombies: A failure of resistance or a means of survival? *Australian Universities Review*, *54*(2), 3–11.

Sibley, D. (2001). The binary city. *Urban Studies*, *38*(2), 239–250.

Singh, T. V. (2012). *Critical issues in tourism*. Bristol: Channel View Publications.

Smith, V. (Ed.). (1976). *Hosts and guests: The anthropology of tourism*. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press.

Snyder, M. (1987). *Public appearances, private realities: The psychology of self-monitoring*. New York: Freeman.

Taleb, N. (2012). *Antifragile: Things that gain from disorder*. New York: Random House.

Thompson Klein, J. T. (1996). *Crossing boundaries: Knowledge, disciplinarities, and interdisciplinarities*. Charlottesville, VA: University of Virginia Press.

Tribe, J. (1997). The indiscipline of tourism. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *3*, 638–657.

Tribe, J. (2005). New tourism research. *Tourism Recreation Research*, *30*(2), 5–8.

Tribe, J. (2008). The art of tourism. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *35*(4), 924–944.

Tribe, J. (2010). Tribes, territories and networks in the tourism academy. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *37*(1), 7–33.

Tribe, J., Dann, G., & Jamal, T. (2015). Paradigms in tourism research: A trialogue. *Tourism Recreation Research*, *40*(1) (28–4).

Tripp, D. (2016). *Georgia*. New York: Random House.

Turner, B. (2002). Response to thrifts 'the future of geography'. *Geoforum*, *33*(4), 427–429.

Turner, V. (1985). *On the edge of the bush: Anthropology as experience*. Tuscon: The University of Arizona Press.

Urry, J. (1990). *The tourist gaze*. London: SAGE Publications.

Vaill, P. (1989). *Managing as a performing art*. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass Publishers.

Voase, R. (1995). *Tourism: The human perspective*. London: Hodder and Stoughton.

Wardle, C., & Buckley, R. (2014). Tourism citations in other disciplines. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *46*, 163–184.

Wescott, D. (2016). Is this economist too far ahead of this time? *The chronicle review* (Oct. 16. Downloaded October 17, 2016 from) http://www.chronicle.com/article/Is-This-Economist-Too-Far/238050?cid=cr&utm_source=cr&utm_medium=en&elqTrackId=2dfc820032144858a77f1a7507b4deb2&elq=6c64854ce0cf4d4fa02f7bccade5a6d1&elqaid=11121&elqat=1&elqCampaignId=4281.

Woodside, A. G. (2015). Advancing tourist gaze research and authenticating the native-visitor: Introduction to a special issue honoring work by John Urry. *International Journal of Culture, Tourism and Hospitality Research*, *9*(4), 373–378.

Xiao, H., Jafari, J., Cloke, P., & Tribe, J. (2013). Annals: 40-40 vision. *Annals of Tourism Research*, *40*, 352–385.

Young, G. (1973). *Tourism:Bblessing or blight*. Penguin.

Edward B. Brooker Ed holds a PhD in Tourism Management (Innovation) from Griffith University, Australia and is currently a Professor, Marketing at the Pilon School of Business, Sheridan College, Ontario, Canada. As a multidisciplinary academic, Ed has presented a number of papers at international conferences on innovation, and co-authored several papers in tourism publications such as the *Journal of Travel Research*, *Journal of Vacation Marketing*, *Tourism Planning & Development*, and the *Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism*.

Marion Joppe Marion is a Professor in the School of Hospitality, Food and Tourism Management; Graduate Faculty, University of Waterloo and Griffith University (Australia); Visiting Professor at MCI (Austria), Shandong University (PRC) and Huaqiao University (PRC); 1st Vice-President of the Travel and Tourism Research Association International, Chair of the Ontario Tourism Marketing Partnership's Metrics Committee, and member of the World Tourism Organization Panel of Tourism Experts.